

# WATER & WASTEWATER

## WHO CONTROLS THE TAP?

Clean water and wastewater treatment are basic public responsibilities. Bill 60 and related provincial policy open the door to corporate control — weakening municipal oversight and making it harder for communities to hold decision-makers accountable.

**BILL 60****MUNICIPAL UTILITIES AT RISK****RATES & SECRECY**

### WHAT BILL 60 CHANGES

The "Your Health Act" and related water legislation are not only about healthcare — they reshape who can own and operate water services.

- New frameworks allow greater private-sector involvement in water and wastewater services.
- Municipalities may face pressure to enter public-private partnerships or sell utility assets.
- Long-term contracts can lock communities in before full costs and risks are understood.
- Environmental compliance and spill response may be harder to enforce under private operators.
- Once privatized, bringing services back under public control is expensive and politically difficult.

### WHAT PRIVATIZATION COSTS COMMUNITIES

Experience in Ontario and elsewhere shows the public still pays — often more — when profits are extracted.

- Private operators must return profit to shareholders; that money comes from ratepayers or service cuts.
- Rate increases often follow privatization despite promises of "efficiency."
- Transparency declines when financial decisions happen behind corporate walls.
- Local councils lose leverage when multi-decade contracts bind future councils.
- Water security during climate emergencies requires public accountability — not quarterly earnings targets.

### QUESTIONS TO ASK LOCALLY

Use these at council meetings, with your MPP, and in local media.

- Who owns our water and wastewater systems today — and who is lobbying to change that?
- What are the full 20-year costs of any proposed partnership vs public operation?
- What happens to rates, jobs, and environmental enforcement if a private operator fails?
- Will the public get open-book audits and council votes before any asset transfer?
- Does this align with municipal climate and watershed protection plans?

### TAKE THE NEXT STEP

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